ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** simple and trusting	Easy prey.
2	**(d)** relative clause	Who-clause describes Hari.
3	**(b)** decided to change his ways	New leaf = fresh start.
4	**(a)** had faith in people	His openness shows trust.
5	**(b)** crafty	Crafty is a synonym.
6	**(c)** climax	The decisive moment.
7	**(c)** good people may believe a thief	Anil's belief shocked him.
8	**(d)** without checking or doubting	Unquestioningly.
9	**(d)** generosity	He shared what little he had.
10	**(c)** he judged people quickly and won their confidence	Skill at manipulating people.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He was friendly and trusting (1) and unaware that Hari was a thief (1).	1+1
12	Anil is simple and trusting; Hari is cunning (1) yet they come to respect each other (1).	1+1
13	It lets us share Hari's thoughts (1) and understand his change from within (1).	1+1
14	Hari wants the money but remembers Anil's kindness (1) and finally the conscience wins at the station (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari expected suspicion but found faith. This shocked him and made him feel valued for the first time. The memory of that trust stopped him at the station and led him back.	1+1+1
16	At the theft he is calculating and eager to flee. At the station he is troubled and ashamed. By the time he returns he is repentant and hopeful.	1+1+1
17	(a) Hari was taught by Anil. (b) Hari returned the money.	1+1+1
	OR: It is where the two meet, in a crowd, with Hari looking for a victim. It also shows Hari's world of cunning among spectators. The match thus begins a meeting that changes his life.	1+1+1
18	Anil never speaks of the theft since he never learns of it. Hari does not confess either. The silent return keeps both their dignity and lets the friendship continue.	1+1+1
	OR: The title says 'The Thief's Story' so the thief is the teller. The first person puts the reader inside his conscience. It makes the reform more convincing.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Hari begins as a cunning thief (1). Anil offers kindness and trust (1). Hari's conscience troubles him (1). He returns the money (1). He wants to study; he is reformed (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hari is illiterate and trapped in crime (1). Anil's offer breaks the cycle (1). Education gives self-respect and work (1). It shapes character (1). Hari's willingness shows its power (1).	2+2+1
20	Hari lives by deceit, Anil by writing (1). Hari is uneducated, Anil literate (1). Hari trusts nobody, Anil trusts all (1). Both are alone (1). Anil's faith brings them together (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Meeting the boy at the wrestling match (1). Offering him work (1). Hiring and teaching (1). Not knowing of the theft (1). Seeing him ready to learn (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.

- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** tense and uncertain	Hari wrestles with his conscience.
2	**(c)** his thoughts and hesitation	First-person reflection.
3	**(d)** no one had offered him a future before	It gave him hope.
4	**(b)** He had been used to suspicion and hardship	He had no affection or education.
5	**(c)** could	'Could have' shows past possibility.
6	**(a)** turning point	The climax of change.
7	**(c)** Hari was offered a job by Anil.	Passive using indirect object.
8	**(d)** Hari had planned to rob Anil.	had + V3.
9	**(c)** He felt unable to board the train	He could not escape his guilt.
10	**(a)** simple and gentle	Plain language, quiet tone.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The story is about inner change, not crime (1) and the quiet tone suits the theme of reform (1).	1+1
12	Hari returned the money before he woke (1) so no confrontation was needed and trust remained intact (1).	1+1
13	Hari had never been offered a chance of education (1) and it promised a respectable life (1).	1+1
14	It stands for escape (1) and is the place where Hari chooses honesty over flight (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari is a thief and chooses to rob, so he does wrong. But he is also a victim of poverty and neglect and has no education. The story treats him with sympathy, not condemnation.	1+1+1
16	The language is simple and conversational. Short sentences carry the first-person voice. The quiet tone and lack of melodrama suit the moral theme.	1+1+1
17	It shows that a boy who steals can choose honesty. Anil's offer of education gives him a future. The ending is calm and hopeful.	1+1+1
	OR: Hari's craft and deception stand against Anil's openness. The wealth Hari wants contrasts with Anil's simple life. The contrast makes Anil's goodness shine.	1+1+1
18	It is risky but shows trust and compassion. Anil sees a boy in need rather than a thief. The decision is rewarded when Hari reforms.	1+1+1
	OR: Anil gives trust freely, while Hari plans betrayal. Hari steals, but then repents. Trust, not punishment, finally defeats betrayal.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Conscience is Hari's inner voice (1). It begins to trouble him after Anil's kindness (1). At the station it prevents his escape (1). It makes him return the money (1). It marks his moral awakening (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Statement of view (1). He returned the money by choice (1). Poverty shaped his past (1). Education gives a fresh start (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Anil's trust in a thief (1). Hari's response (1). Everyday examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hari studies the room and money (1). He waits for night (1). He steals and hurries to the station (1). His mind is in conflict (1). The tension ends with his return (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.

- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.
- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 11: **The Thief's Story (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Young Thief Returns Stolen Money	Reflects the main event.
2	**(c)** he never has to condemn the boy	No confrontation is needed.
3	**(c)** trust, wealth	He chose trust.
4	**(b)** mentor and learner	Anil becomes a teacher figure.
5	**(d)** reform over punishment	The tone is hopeful.
6	**(c)** Hari put the money back under the mattress.	Recorded event.
7	**(c)** it shows Anil had little but trusted fully	Poverty contrasts with generosity.
8	**(a)** If Anil had doubted him, Hari might not have changed.	Conditional sentence.
9	**(c)** Hari deserved a second chance.	Judgement, not fact.
10	**(b)** figurative, meaning guilt	Metaphor for guilt.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A chance to start again after wrong-doing (1) which Anil's trust and lessons give Hari (1).	1+1
12	He has begun to value trust over money (1) and is ready to change his ways (1).	1+1
13	Hari would have run off with the money (1) and remained a thief (1).	1+1
14	It gave him a place in Anil's house (1) and a chance to observe where money was kept, yet also to feel valued (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Hari cannot read, which keeps him on the wrong path. Anil offers to teach him. At the end Hari's desire to learn replaces the desire to steal.	1+1+1
16	Hari said that he wanted to learn to read. The present tense becomes past and 'I' becomes 'he'.	1+1+1
17	He may have felt relief and shame at once. He would have thought of the lessons Anil promised. He would have hoped to deserve Anil's trust in future.	1+1+1
	OR: People can be both good and bad. A kind act can awaken the good in a wrongdoer. Society should trust and teach rather than only punish.	1+1+1
18	(a) What did Hari steal from the mattress? / From where did Hari steal money? (b) What did Anil write? Each question asks about the underlined part correctly.	1+1+1
	OR: The title promises a thief's own account. It places the reader on his side. It shows that the story is about the inner life of a wrongdoer.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	The climax is at the railway station (1). Hari holds the money and has a chance to flee (1). He thinks of Anil (1). He chooses to go back (1). The decision resolves the conflict (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). The story of Hari (1). The role of kindness (1). Everyday examples (1). Closing appeal (1).	2+2+1
20	Address and date (1). Salutation (1). Introduction of Hari and his skills (1). Plan to teach him (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The money is returned secretly (1). Anil does not know (1). The friendship is saved (1). Hari looks forward to learning (1). The ending shows hope (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Hari Singh is a student; he is a **fifteen-year-old thief**, narrating in the first person, who tries to rob the writer Anil.
- Mixing Anil's response: he offers Hari **food, work and lessons**, and when Hari returns the notes Anil quietly shows he knows, without exposing him.
- Forgetting the notes episode: Hari puts the notes back under Anil's mattress; *this* is the moral turning point of the story.

- Treating money as Hari's only motive; he also wants to become a **respected, educated man**, which draws him to Anil.
- Saying Anil caught him and called the police; the story ends in **trust**, with Anil handing him a wet fifty-rupee note.
- Spelling slips: *Ruskin Bond, thief, Anil, wrestler, mattress*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND